

Nikesh Kumar

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EDUCATION

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor – School of Information

Aug 2023 – May 2025

Master of Science in Information – UX/HCI Specialization

Ann Arbor, MI

- **Relevant Coursework:** Interaction Design, Graphic Design, Contextual Inquiry, Fundamentals of Human Behavior

Manipal Institute of Technology

Jul 2018 – Jul 2022

Bachelor of Technology in Information Technology with Minors in Big Data

Manipal, Karnataka

- **Relevant Coursework:** Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), Social Network Analysis, Software Engineering, Android and Web Technologies, International Business Management, Graphic & Sketching
- **Achievements:** Mentored students in Engineering Mathematics II through doubt sessions, paper creation, performance assessments, and summarized notes.

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

- **UI/UX:** Figma, UX (Affinity mapping, User Personas, Wireframing, Prototyping), Adobe Suite (Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects), Affinity Designer & Publisher, Blender/Cinema 4D, Google Suite (Docs, Drive, Forms), HTML, CSS, JS
- **Technologies:** C++, C, Python, JavaScript, Java, SQL (Mongo, PostgreSQL, Oracle), Web Frameworks (React JS, Express, Node JS, Flask, Beautiful Soup), Android Development, Firebase, Heroku, Digital Ocean, Amazon AWS, Microsoft Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook), AutoCAD, LaTeX
- **Coursera:** Foundations of User Experience Design (Google), Fundamentals of Graphic Design (Calarts)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tejas Networks Ltd.

Mumbai, India

R&D Engineer (Intern from Jan 2022 – Jun 2022)

Aug 2022 – Aug 2023

- Developing APIs in C++/C to effectively communicate between processor and external devices in a modular pattern to allow room for scalability in future and detailed documenting for accessibility
- Notably, I took initiative to streamline a resource intense testing methodology by developing a local environment to improve productivity and have also automated repetitive tasks using Python and shell scripting

MITACS – University of Waterloo

Remote

GRI Intern - UI & Web Developer

Jun 2021 – Sep 2021

- Incorporated design patterns from adjacent competitors in low-fidelity designs on Figma to improve user experience and developed higher-fidelity on Affinity for the prototyping.
- Modeled the boilerplate code on MERN, then programmed different web pages and a encapsulated API class for calls between the backend, frontend & AWS using principles of software design allowing replicability

PROJECTS EXPERIENCE

Microsoft Design Challenge – Well Being during the Pandemic

- Using secondary data sources, identified issues in working habits of employed professionals and designed a work-hours tracker for Windows and a community mode, along with a utility pane for MS Teams, on Affinity Designer. More than 75% of users in a survey showed positive reception to the changes.

Mess Management App - Don't Starve

- Realized potential NFC and geotagging applications at reducing plastic wastage and carbon footprint by digitizing the mess cards and using geotagging for crowd statistics, submitted as a final project to Android Lab.
- Used native OCR and admin approval (ReactJS) to verify students for food token access and Firebase for backend

Censure – <https://censure.vercel.app/>

- Identified an issue with uncensored personal data being sent across on social boards and developed and designed a website to allow the censoring of sensitive personal data using HTML and Nanonets.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Her Campus at Manipal

Mumbai, India

Co-Head of Graphic Design, Art & Photo Department (Member for first 3 months) · GDAP

Feb 2020 – May 2021

- Designed and supervised the club magazine, Instagram posts, t-shirts, collaboration & events with engagement reaching more than 25k.
- Achieved gold chapter recognition and a 40% growth of followers from 800.